to the people and young women and children were shot dead; the answer given was political exploitation by certain groups. I saw the people. There might have been some political groups here and there but the vast majority of the people were peace-loving, were anxious to co-operate with the Government. They did not know what politics was. I saw ladies, illiterate who had never seen politics and they asked: 'After attainment of freedom, is this state of affairs that is to come to our country? We cannot get our rice even when it is there and when we ask for it, we get bullets in place of rice.' If you say that you want more and more powers for curbing such situations, you will fail and hopelessly fail.

Shri Sidhva: If there was so much food, why was there any riot?

Dr S.P. Mookerjee: You come to me and I will explain it.

I therefore say that the Prime Minister has not succeeded in pointing out any reason why the amendment to Article 19 should be made as proposed.

Let me deal with foreign relations. The Prime Minister said that it was not his intention that criticism of foreign powers should be curbed. I have been trying to read the Constitution of other countries and I have also been trying to find out from case law – and in this Dr Ambedkar might be able to help us – and I have not been able to find any precedent in any part of the civilized world whereby law under the provisions of the Constitution criticism of foreign powers is taboo. Who will be the person who will be first affected if you pass this law? It will be our Prime Minister, Pandit Jawarharlal Nehru. Will he then be able to say that if Pakistan encroaches one inch more into the territory of Kashmir he will consider it as a war on India? That will offend Pakistan and he cannot make that statement.

Shri JawaharIal Nehru: May I point out that I said nothing about criticism of foreign powers being prohibited.

Dr S.P. Mookerjee: I am glad about it. We can discuss this question later on. But the way in which the wording has been suggested here – affecting friendly relations with foreign powers – is hardly reassuring. Who is to